

The Before / After Shot Guide

Every job is content. Two minutes of photos turns one paid job into a week of marketing. This is how to shoot it so the photos are actually usable — keep it on your phone and run it on every job, starting with the June 17 clear-out.

THE 90-SECOND ROUTINE ON EVERY JOB

1 · Arrive → shoot BEFORE

Before you touch anything. Wide + 1–2 detail shots.

2 · Note your spot

Mentally mark exactly where you stood and how you framed it.

3 · Finish → shoot AFTER

Same spot, same angle, same zoom. That match is the whole point.

1 Framing & angle — the one rule that matters

If the before and after don't line up, the comparison is wasted. Matching beats perfect.

- **Stand in the same spot** for before and after — pick a landmark (a corner, a post) to stand on.
- **Same height & angle** — shoot at chest height, level, not tilted down.
- **Don't zoom with fingers** — step closer/back instead; pinch-zoom kills quality.
- **Fill the frame with the work** — the dirty driveway, not the whole street.
- **Shoot wide first, then details** — 1 wide establishing shot + 2–3 close-ups of the worst grime/damage.
- **Hold the phone horizontal (landscape)** for website + before/after sliders; grab a vertical too for Stories/Reels.
- **Keep it steady** — both hands, brief pause, or lean on something.
- **Leave a little margin** around the subject so it can be cropped later.

2 Lighting & conditions

Coastal light is harsh midday. A few habits keep photos crisp and true-to-color.

- **Keep the sun behind you**, lighting the subject — not in the frame.
- **Avoid deep shadow + bright sun in one shot** — it blows out the detail.
- **Overcast is your friend** — even, soft light shows grime and results best.
- **Match the weather** — don't shoot "before" in sun and "after" in rain; it reads as a trick.
- **Wipe the lens** — salt mist films it fast out here.
- **Dry surfaces if you can** — wet "after" concrete looks darker, not cleaner.

⚠ Consent & privacy — do this before anything is posted

Get the owner's or PM's **OK before photographing a property**, and a second OK before anything is posted publicly. **Don't show** house numbers, full street signs, license plates, faces, mail/names, or anything that identifies **where** the home is — absentee owners care about this. When in doubt, frame tighter or note "address withheld." All photos come back to Ray for approval; nothing posts on its own.

3 One job → five assets (the capture list)

Shoot with these five uses in mind and a single visit feeds a week of content.

Asset	What to capture for it
1. Before/after pair	Matched wide shots, same angle — the hero image for a website slider and social post.
2. Google Business post	One strong after (or the pair) + the service + the town/area (no exact address).
3. Community / Nextdoor post	The pair plus 1 detail close-up; neighbor-friendly, "here's a job we did nearby."
4. Review request	A clean after to text the customer with the review link — "loved how it turned out? a quick review helps a ton."
5. Future ad creative	The horizontal pair + a vertical version, kept in the library for paid ads later.

4 Staging the shot — small touches, big difference

✓ Do

- Clear hoses, tools, cones, and your gear out of the after shot.
- Coil cords, close gates, square up furniture.
- Capture the **worst spot** before — that's the proof.
- Get a junk-load **"full truck/trailer"** then **"empty space"** pair for clear-outs.

✗ Don't

- Leave your truck, feet, or shadow in the frame.
- Over-edit — no heavy filters; it should look real.
- Stage damage or exaggerate the before.
- Shoot into the sun or through a dirty lens.

Where the photos go

Drop every set into **Marketing/Photos/before-after/**, named **date_service_location** (e.g. *2026-06-17_clearout_kittyhawk*). Keep the before and after together. That naming makes them instantly findable when we build posts and the website gallery.

For the June 17 clear-out specifically

This is the first job through the proof machine — capture it well. Get the **full-trailer** → **cleared-space** pair, a wide of the area before/after, and 2–3 detail shots. Confirm the owner/PM is fine with photos first, and keep the location out of frame. Five good assets from this one job kick off the whole content calendar.

POCKET CHECKLIST

☐ Permission to shoot

Owner/PM OK before photos.

☐ BEFORE: wide + details

Before you touch anything.

☐ Mark your spot & angle

Landmark to stand on.

☐ AFTER: match it exactly

Same spot, height, zoom.

☐ Hide gear, no address

Clean frame, location private.

☐ Save & name the set

date_service_location.